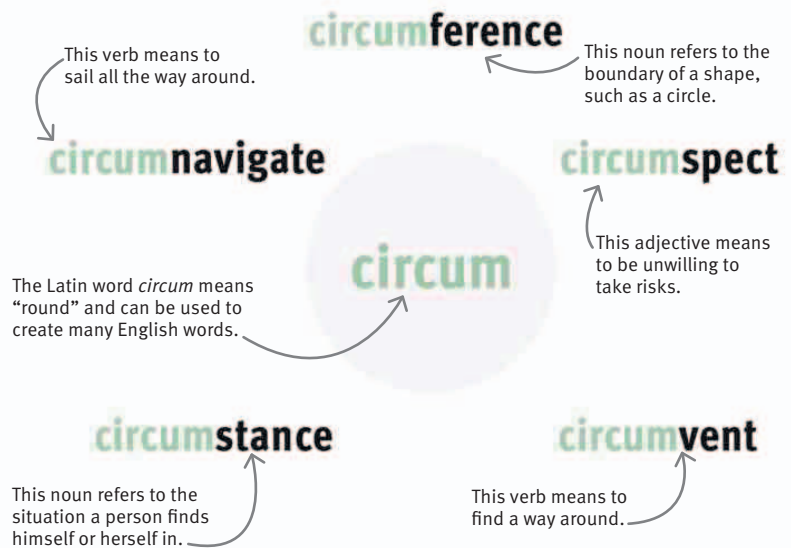


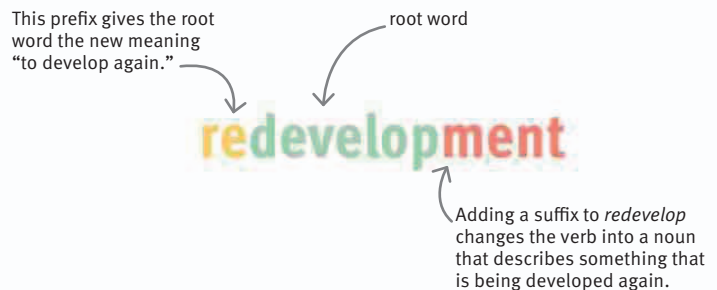
Meanings

Many English words come from Latin or Greek, and learning to recognize these roots and understand what they mean can help with spelling. For example, *mar* is the Latin word for “sea,” and it is used in the English words *marine* and *maritime*. A common Greek example is *dec*, which means “ten,” and this is used in the English words *decade* and *decathlon*. Some root words, such as *build*, which comes from the Old English word *byldan*, are instantly recognizable and form the basis for other related words, including *building*, *builder*, and *rebuild*.



Word beginnings and endings

Some words can have an extra part added to them, which results in a new word. This addition is called a prefix (word beginning) or a suffix (word ending) and can change the meaning of the word. For example, *social* acquires the opposite meaning when the prefix *anti-* is added, resulting in *antisocial*. However, when the suffix *-ite* is added to the same root word, the result is *socialite*, which refers to a person who enjoys social activities.



Choose the right words

In some cases, spelling errors can produce a different meaning from the one expected. This is especially true when words that are spelled differently but pronounced the same (homophones) create unintentional, but sometimes amusing, results.

